

THE RISE OF ROME

By 100 CE, Rome was the grandest city on Earth and the center of a massive empire. Home to about 1 million people, it was a fabulous place, with sumptuous palaces, grand statues, magnificent triumphal arches celebrating Rome's victories, and of course the Colosseum—the finest gladiator stadium in the Roman Empire. Often, the Roman people wondered how and when it had all begun.

The wolf and the twins

Like many peoples of the ancient world, the Romans made up stories to explain things about themselves and their world. In time, these stories, or myths, became accepted as true facts rather than invented tales.

To explain the origins of their city, the Romans told one of the best-known myths of all time—the story of the twin boys Romulus and Remus.

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